Navigating Grief: Understanding Loss & Finding Your Way

An 8-lesson compassionate course on grief as a natural response — with no fixed timeline and no right way

Your Grief Is Valid

If you're here, you're likely going through one of the hardest experiences a person can face. Before anything else: **your grief is valid.**

> However it looks, however it feels, however long it takes — it is a real and natural response to real loss.

However It Looks

There is no single expression of grief. Yours is uniquely yours.

However It Feels

Every emotion you experience — even the unexpected ones — belongs here.

However Long It Takes

There is no deadline. No timeline. No finish line you must reach.

Grief Is Bigger Than You Think

Grief isn't just about death. People grieve the loss of relationships, health, abilities, homes, careers, safety, dreams, and identity. It is a **whole-person experience** that touches every part of who you are.

Your Body

Exhaustion, physical pain, changes in appetite and sleep — grief lives in the body as much as the mind.

Your Mind

Confusion, disbelief, difficulty concentrating — cognitive fog is a deeply common grief experience.

Your Emotions

Sadness, anger, guilt, relief — sometimes all at once. No feeling is wrong or out of place.

Your Behavior

Withdrawal, restlessness, changes in routine — grief reshapes how we move through the world.

What You'll Learn

This course offers compassionate, evidence-based psychoeducation across 8 carefully designed lessons. Here is what each part of the journey covers:

1. **Grief as a Natural Response**
   Understanding grief as a whole-person response to many kinds of loss — not just death.

2. **Common Grief Experiences**
   Physical, emotional, cognitive, and behavioral dimensions of grief explored with compassion.

3. **Challenging Harmful Myths**
   There are no fixed stages or timelines. We dismantle the myths that make grief harder.

4. **Coping with Grief Waves**
   Practical tools for navigating waves of grief and planning for triggers like anniversaries.

5. **Compassionate Self-Care**
   Practices that support your nervous system and honor your body's need for rest and care.

6. **Continuing Bonds**
   Maintaining meaningful connection with who or what was lost — without letting go.

7. **Building a Support System**
   Personal, professional, and community resources to help you feel less alone.

8. **Finding Meaning**
   Discovering meaning without pressure to move on, forget, or reach a final destination.

Beyond the Five Stages

The **"five stages of grief"** model is outdated and often harmful. It was never designed as a universal roadmap — yet it has been used to judge and rush grieving people for decades.

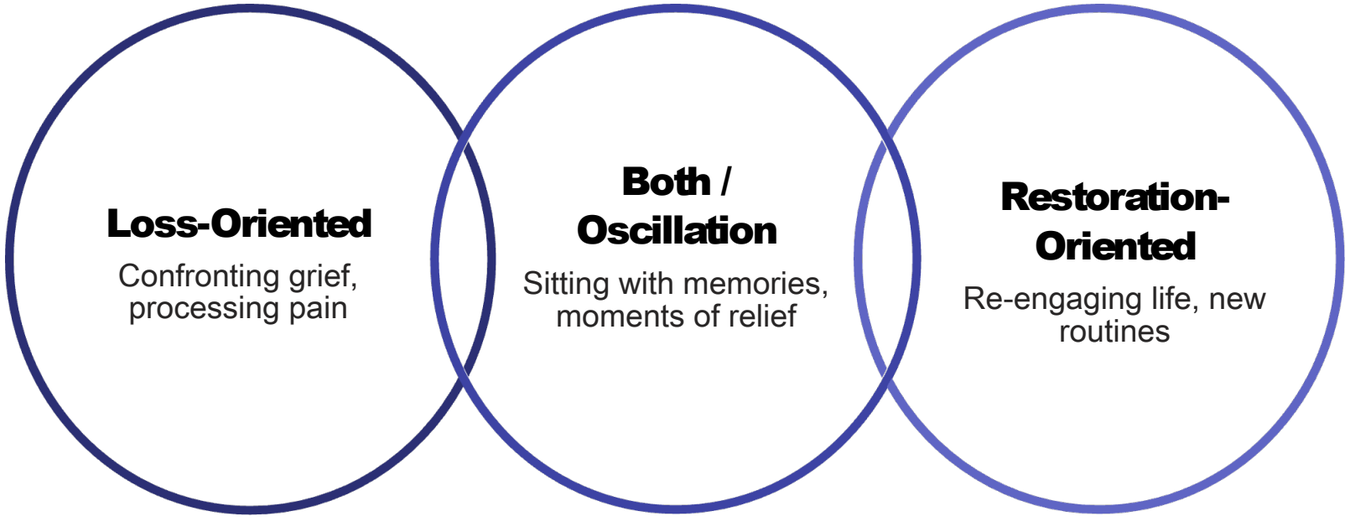
Modern grief research offers a more humane and accurate framework: the **Dual Process Model**. Rather than moving through fixed stages, you naturally oscillate between two orientations — and both are healthy, both are necessary.

Loss-Oriented

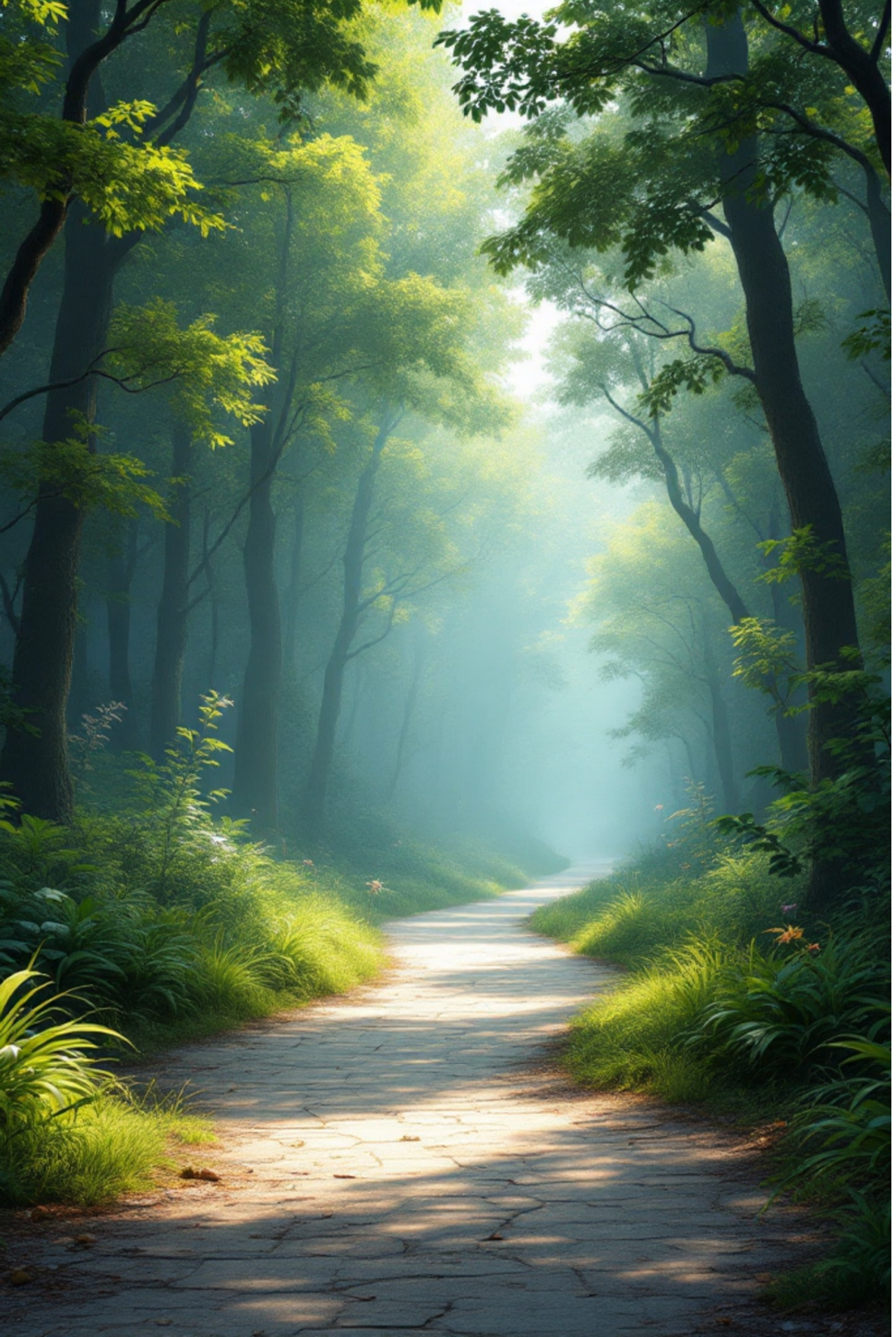
Confronting and processing the grief itself — sitting with pain, tears, memories, and the reality of what has changed.

Restoration-Oriented

Re-engaging with life — attending to daily tasks, building new routines, and finding moments of relief or even joy.



This oscillation is not a sign of weakness or inconsistency — it is the natural rhythm of healing.



Course Structure

This course is built around one core belief: **there is no right way to grieve.** Everything here is designed to meet you where you are.

8

Lessons

Thoughtfully sequenced to guide you through every dimension of grief.

8–10

Hours

Flexible, self-paced learning you can return to whenever you're ready.

Dual Process Model

Grounded in the most current, compassionate framework in grief research.

Evidence-Based

Compassionate psychoeducation rooted in modern clinical understanding of loss.

No Timelines

No shoulds. No deadlines. No pressure to feel a certain way by a certain point.

Self-Paced

Move through the material at whatever pace honors where you are right now.